

# ABDULAZEEZ APATA

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## PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Fintech Product Manager with experience building and scaling payment, transfer, savings, and financial services products in Nigeria. Experienced in owning end-to-end product delivery across customer-facing applications, backend services, API integrations, operational workflows, and payment infrastructure. Skilled in driving product strategy, defining requirements, managing roadmaps, and partnering closely with Engineering, Operations, and Compliance to deliver reliable, secure, and scalable financial products. Proven track record of improving transaction performance, optimizing integrations, launching new products from concept to market, and using data to drive product decisions. Experienced in payments, transfers, merchant services, API-driven products, digital banking, operational tooling, and cross-functional stakeholder management within highly regulated fintech environments.

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## CORE COMPETENCIES

- Product Strategy and Roadmapping
  - Product Discovery & Requirements Definition
  - API-Driven Product Development
  - End-to-End Product Ownership (Discovery → Scale)
  - Backend Service Collaboration & System Dependencies
  - Cross-Functional Leadership and Stakeholder Management
  - Agile Delivery & Sprint Management
  - Business Banking Products
  - Developer Experience & Integrations
  - Virtual Accounts & Account Services
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## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

**TM30 Global Limited** | Lagos, Nigeria

*Product Manager* | January 2026 – Present

- Lead product development for an IT Asset Management System, a telecom asset and identity management platform, defining product requirements, user stories, and roadmap in partnership with engineering, operations, and compliance stakeholders.
- Own product strategy for Fraud Analyzer, an API-first AML and fraud detection platform, translating regulatory requirements into product capabilities, and implementation roadmaps for fraud prevention and compliance product.
- Provide product leadership across three concurrent product workstreams, setting strategic priorities, resolving cross-functional dependencies, managing competing stakeholder needs, and serving as the primary point of accountability for successful product delivery.
- Produce enterprise-grade product documentation, including Functional Requirements Documents (FRDs), Product Requirements Documents (PRDs), user stories, acceptance criteria, and process flows to enable disciplined Agile execution across distributed engineering teams.
- Conduct market research and competitive analysis across the Nigerian fintech landscape to identify opportunities in digital banking, payments, merchant services, identity verification, and financial infrastructure.

- Partner closely with engineering, compliance, operations, and business stakeholders to align product delivery with regulatory requirements, operational objectives, and organizational strategy.
- Drive backlog prioritization, sprint planning, and release planning, ensuring engineering efforts remain aligned with business priorities, regulatory deadlines, and customer needs.

### **KongaPay Technologies | Lagos, Nigeria**

*Product Manager | August 2024 – January 2026*

- Own product strategy and delivery for payment, transfer, and financial services products, collaborating with Engineering, Operations, Compliance, and Commercial teams to improve customer and merchant experiences.
- Led enhancements to payment and transfer infrastructure by monitoring transaction success rates, identifying integration failures, investigating production issues, and prioritizing reliability improvements, resulting in an 11% increase in service efficiency.
- Partnered closely with backend and platform engineering teams to define API requirements, improve service integrations, optimize transaction processing workflows, and reduce system bottlenecks affecting transaction performance.
- Drove the end-to-end development and launch of K-Save from concept to market, defining product requirements, customer journeys, operational processes, and go-to-market strategy, contributing to over ₦2 billion in transaction volume within its first year.
- Collaborated with internal stakeholders to streamline operational workflows, improve issue resolution processes, and support scalable service delivery across payment and banking products.
- Worked with engineering teams on platform scalability, service resilience, and architecture decisions supporting growth, regulatory compliance, and operational reliability.

### **Easy Bill | Lagos, Nigeria**

*Product Manager | February 2023 – August 2024*

- Managed the end-to-end product lifecycle for key bill payment and utility services, delivering features that improved user satisfaction and contributed to recurring revenue growth.
- Collaborated with engineering teams to manage and optimize integrations with third-party biller and payment APIs, improving transaction reliability, response handling, and service uptime.
- Collaborated with leadership to define product KPIs and align feature prioritization with quarterly revenue goals.
- Worked with operations and customer support teams to identify service issues, prioritize enhancements, and reduce customer friction across bill payment journeys.
- Drove alignment across engineering, operations, and leadership through structured roadmap and review sessions.
- Led backlog grooming and roadmap reviews, prioritizing initiatives that drove measurable adoption gains and system reliability improvements.
- Advocated for a data-informed product culture, implementing usage analytics and performance tracking to identify friction points and improve customer retention.

### **Adanian Lab | Lagos, Nigeria**

*Frontend Web Developer | July 2022 - February 2023*

- Collaborated with product and design teams to translate user requirements into intuitive, responsive web interfaces that improved usability and adoption.
  - Applied modern front-end technologies to deliver scalable, high-performing applications across multiple devices.
  - Provided technical input during product feasibility reviews, bridging the gap between engineering constraints and product intent.
  - Developed a strong understanding of engineering workflows and technical feasibility, shaping a foundation for data-informed product decision-making.
  - Gained foundational experience with API integrations, front-end consumption of backend services, and cross-system data flows
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## EDUCATION

### Ahmadu Bello University

Master's in Public Health, 2025

### University of Ilorin

Bachelor's in Biochemistry | 2018

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## CERTIFICATIONS

- ISO 20000 IT Service Management System Lead Implementer | 2025
  - Data-Driven Product Management | LinkedIn Learning | 2024
  - Product Roadmapping Certification | Product School | 2024
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## REFEREE

Available on request